NEVER FIGHT OR ARGUE AGAIN

L.U.V. Your Spouse Through Conflict

The LUV Framework is a Spirit-led way to respond after someone shares pain in a conflict conversation. It shifts the focus from resolution to reconnection. *This is not a technique to get through the moment. It's a ministry to offer in the moment.*

THE MAKE-OR-BREAK MOMENT

Your spouse has just shared their pain. Your first impulse might be to: ✕ jump in and clarify your side, ✕ apologize quickly to make it end, ✕ offer a different perspective, ✕ defend your character. In that moment, your spouse isn't looking for resolution; they're looking for recognition.

L Listen

Listening deeply, actively, and without judgment

Real listening means letting go of the urge to correct, interpret, judge, or plan your response.

HOW TO DO IT

- **Deep:** track pain, tone, history, and heart.
- **Active:** stay mentally and emotionally engaged.
- **Non-judgmental:** don't filter their words through guilt, defensiveness, or pride.
- **Drive-Through:** reflect what you heard before you offer anything else.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

"What I hear you saying is that when I said that in front of our friends, you felt embarrassed and dismissed."

"Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry." **James 1:19**

U Understand

Understanding with empathy

Understanding is not the same as agreement. You can make room for their feelings without correcting the details.

HOW TO DO IT

- **Pause internally.** Don't rush.
- **Imagine their experience.** Ask: What would that moment have felt like to me if I were them? What message did they receive from my words or actions?
- **Speak your understanding.**

SAY IT LIKE THIS

"I can understand why that moment hit you that way. That would have felt lonely."

"...not looking to your own interests but each of you to the interests of the others." **Philippians 2:4**

V Validate

Validation that the concern is legitimate

Validating is not agreeing with every conclusion your spouse drew. It is honoring that the feeling was real.

HOW TO DO IT

- **Affirm the feeling:** "Your emotions make sense." "You're not being too sensitive." "I can see why it felt that way."
- **Leave out** the explanations that used to come with the apology.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

"You're right to feel hurt. I can see that now, and I respect you for saying something."

"To answer before listening, that is folly and shame." **Proverbs 18:13**

NO VALIDATION *"You're taking this too personally."*

Result: re-escalation, shut down, distrust, emotional re-injury.

VALIDATION *"That makes total sense. I didn't see it before, but I do now."*

Result: emotional release, trust begins to restore, tears, softness, relief, a new path forward.

WHY LUV MUST PRECEDE EVERYTHING ELSE

Before apology, before solution, before reconciliation, comes LUV. If your spouse doesn't feel heard, understood, or validated, they won't be able to receive anything else you say.

WHEN TO USE IT

Use LUV as your default posture when your spouse shares anything vulnerable. It will keep you from reacting, and teach you how to respond with reverence.

"Your spouse will forget most of what you say. But they will never forget how you made them feel in their moment of vulnerability."

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